BJP

CM contenders: **N. Biren Singh, 61; Govindas Konthoujam Singh, 58; Thongam Biswajit Singh, 47**
Alliance partner: **Naga People's Front (NPF), but both are contesting separately**

STRENGTHS

- Peace in Manipur in the past five years
- CM Biren Singh's outreach programme to bridge the gap between hills and valley
- Organisational and financial strength of the party

CHALLENGES

- Public discontent over poor infrastructure, unemployment.
- Disgruntled ticket-seekers may sabotage chances of BJP candidates
- Infighting over CM's post



EAR TO THE GROUND N. Biren Singh (centre) campaigns in Saikul constituency, Feb. 10

Photographs by CHANDRADEEP KUMAR

ASSEMBLY POLLS 2022

MANIPUR

TREADING THE FAULT LINES

Ethnic divide, insurgent threats, AFSPA, unemployment, difficult allies—the ruling BJP and rival Congress face multiple issues and new challenger NPP in elections to this border state

BY KAUSHIK DEKA